



**FEBRUARY 19th 2026
CHARTER REVISION COMMISSION
AGENDA**

Date: Thursday February 19, 2026

Time: 6:00 PM

Location: 108 E Green Street

Watch Online: <https://www.youtube.com/@CityofIthacaPublicMeetings>

1. Call to Order

1.1 Emergency Evacuation Notice

2. Agenda Review

3. Introductions of Commissioners

4. Adoption of Organizing & Video Conferencing Resolutions

4.1 Adoption of Organizing Resolution

4.2 Opt-in to City video-conferencing ordinance

5. Charge, Scope, & Process

5.1 Presentation of Charter Revision Process Overview (City Attorney's Office)

5.2 Mandate & Timeline

5.3 Commission Scope

5.4 Open Meetings Law (OML) Compliance

5.5 Decision Making Norms

6. Committee Structure & Broad Assignments

6.1 Overview of Working Group & Steering Committee Procedure

6.2 Announcement of Working Group Assignments

7. Next Steps & Adjournment

7.1 Immediate Actions

7.2 Next Meeting Date

No Public Comments.

Not all meetings include a Public Comment segment. The City of Ithaca wants to hear from you and encourages community members to share comments with the Common Council using the option below.

To Submit Written Comments please use the link below. Public Comment Form Written comments submitted will be compiled and entered into the record.

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**The City of Ithaca, New
York**

*Charter Revision Commission
Ithaca City Hall, 108 E. Green St.
Ithaca, NY 14850*

Resolution No. 1

A Resolution to Organize the Charter Revision Commission

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca Charter Revision Commission (“Commission”) has been constituted pursuant to an appointment by Robert G. Cantelmo, the Mayor to review and propose revisions to the City Charter within the sixty-day organizational period established by the Mayor; and

WHEREAS, the Commission will conduct its meetings and organization in compliance with the New York State Open Meetings Law; and

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED, that the Commission hereby adopts the following organizing provisions:

1. Meetings

- 1.1. The Commission shall convene for a regular meeting on the Third Thursday of each month at 6:00 pm in Common Council Chambers, third Floor, City Hall, 108 E. Green Street.
- 1.2. Meetings shall not be more than two (2) hours in length, unless specified in the notice of meeting or modified by the Commission.
- 1.3. Attendance is mandatory, although the Chair may excuse a member from attendance for justifiable reasons.

2. Transaction of Business

- 2.1. Each Commissioner shall have one vote. No Commissioner may abstain from voting, except in cases where a conflict of interest is present. If a conflict of interest is present, the Commissioner will state the conflict before the commission.
- 2.2. A quorum shall be a majority of the voting power of the Commission. A quorum shall be required to transact business, but less than a quorum shall have the power to adjourn. The Commission may only transact business with an affirmative vote of a majority of the voting power of the Commission at a meeting where a quorum is present; however, committees of the Commission may transact business with a majority of voting power present.



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3. Order of Business

3.1. The Order of Business for each future regular meeting shall be as follows:

- 3.1.1. Call to Order & Call of Roll
- 3.1.2. Adoption of Minutes
- 3.1.3. Special Orders of Business
- 3.1.4. Testimonies and Witness Statements
- 3.1.5. Reports from Working Group Chairs
- 3.1.6. Consideration of Resolutions
- 3.1.7. Appointments
- 3.1.8. Adjournment

4. Parliamentarian & Counsel

- 4.1. The Office of the City Attorney is hereby designated to serve as Parliamentarian to the Commission, in an advisory capacity, to assist with procedural questions and meeting administration.

5. Chair, Committees & Working Groups

- 5.1. The Chair is authorized to create, modify, and dissolve advisory committees and working groups of the Commission, inclusive of appointing officers, filling vacancies, and appointing members, consistent with applicable law, the Open Meetings Law, and *Robert's Rules of Order*.

6. Steering Committee

- 6.1. A Steering Committee is established, consisting of the Commission's officers, with the Chair authorized to appoint up to two additional members from the general body of the Commission.
- 6.2. The Steering Committee will guide the Commission's work, consult with the Chair on forming or dissolving advisory committees and working groups, advise on internal appointments and vacancies, and may compile questions for committees or working groups to develop recommendations for the full Commission's consideration on timelines the Steering Committee sets.



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7. Internal Vacancies of Officers

- 7.1. In the case of the absence of the Chair at a meeting of the Commission or Steering Committee, the Vice Chair shall serve as Chair. In the case of the absence of both the Chair and the Vice Chair, the Secretary shall serve as Chair.

8. Duties of Officers

- 8.1. Consistent with Section 36 of the Municipal Home Rule Law, the Chair shall have the power to conduct the day-to-day business of the Commission, including but not limited to the authority to enter contracts on behalf of the Commission, appoint and remove staff, fix their compensation, and establish policies and procedures necessary to ensure the professional and orderly conduct of the Commission's work: Provided, the Chair shall not perform any of the duties set forth in this section in a manner contrary to an action performed by the Steering Committee. In cases where there shall be a conflict between an action of the Chair and one of the Steering Committee, the action of the Steering Committee shall prevail.
- 8.2. The Chair may request and accept any and all services, facilities, materials, data or funds on behalf of the Commission in accordance with Section 36 of the Municipal Home Rule Law.
- 8.3. The Secretary shall have the power to take steps necessary, consistent with any actions taken by the Commission, to ensure that the Commission, committees, and other bodies formed by the Commission meet as appropriate, including scheduling and providing notice of meetings and hearings, and preparing and distributing agendas and determining the business considered, order of business for meetings, and hearings. The secretary shall be the Steering Committee's liaison to each working group, and other bodies formed by the Commission or the Steering Committee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that this resolution shall take effect immediately upon adoption.



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Resolution No. 2

Resolution Opting In to City of Ithaca Videoconferencing Provisions

WHEREAS, the Common Council of the City of Ithaca adopted Local Law No. 5 of 2022 authorizing public bodies to conduct meetings by videoconference pursuant to New York Public Officers Law §103-a; and

WHEREAS, said local law permits, but does not require, public bodies to opt in to videoconferencing subject to specified procedural safeguards; and

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca Charter Revision Commission (“Commission”) wishes to promote accessibility and permit remote participation in meetings in a manner consistent with that local law and applicable state law;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED, that the Commission hereby opts in to the City of Ithaca’s videoconferencing provisions as set forth in **Local Law No. 5 of 2022**, as amended, and authorizes the use of videoconferencing for Commission meetings in compliance with the Open Meetings Law and City requirements.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that when videoconferencing is utilized, the Commission shall comply with all applicable requirements of Local Law No. 5 of 2022 and Public Officers Law §103-a, including but not limited to:

1. Maintaining a quorum in accordance with law;
2. Permitting remote participation only under circumstances authorized by law and City policy;
3. Ensuring that members participating remotely can be heard, seen, and identified during the meeting;
4. Providing advance public notice when videoconferencing will be used;
5. Recording meetings conducted with videoconferencing and making such recordings available to the public as required; and

6. Noting in the meeting minutes which members participated remotely.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that participation by videoconference shall not alter quorum requirements, voting procedures, or any other obligations imposed by law.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that this resolution shall take effect immediately upon adoption.



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Announcement of Steering Committee & Working Group Appointments

Pursuant to the authority of the Chair, I am announcing the appointment of a standing steering committee, and working groups of the City of Ithaca Charter Revision Commission.

These appointments were informed by the assignment preference survey, members' stated bandwidth and accessibility considerations, along with the goal of balancing expertise, continuity, and representation across committees and working groups. All working groups are advisory to the full Commission, while the Steering Committee guides the process.

The committee appointments are as follows:

Steering Committee

- Billy Noseworthy, Chair
- Kris Haines-Sharp, Vice Chair
- Clyde Lederman, Secretary
- Victor Kessler, Member
- Miranda Pagan, Member

Legislative Powers Working Group

- Kristina Thelen, Working Group Chair
- George McGonigal, Member
- Travis Brooks, Member
- Nels Bohn, Member
- Clyde Lederman, Liason

Elections Working Group

- Donna Fleming, Working Group Chair
- Tiffany Kumar, Member
- Deborah Fisher, Member
- Miranda Pagan, Member
- Clyde Lederman, Liason

General Charter Revisions Working Group

- Aryeal Jackson, Working Group Chair
- Cynthia Brock, Member
- Kristina Thelen, Member
- Pierre Saint-Perez, Member
- Clyde Lederman, Liason

Each working group shall have one additional member, appointed by the Office of the City Attorney.

These appointments take effect immediately. Working groups are encouraged to organize their initial meetings, coordinate schedules mindful of accessibility needs, and report regularly to the full Commission.

To support transparency and shared understanding, working groups are requested to circulate meeting minutes or notes to the full Commission within one week of each meeting.

I want to thank all commissioners for their flexibility and willingness to serve. If any member has a concern regarding their assignment, I ask that they contact me directly so we can address it promptly.

This announcement will be entered into the record.